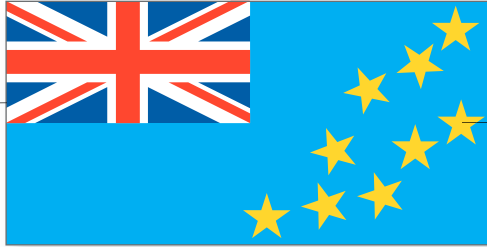


Tuvalu

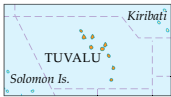
Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** October 1, 1978 **Usage:** National and Civil

The Union Jack signifies continuing links with Britain



The nine stars are for the nine islands

Australasia and Oceania



The Ellice Islands separated from the Gilbert and Ellice Islands in 1975, and adopted the name **Tuvalu**. Independence was gained in 1978.

Tuvalu means “eight islands,” although there are in fact nine, each of which is represented by a star on the flag. The stars’ arrangement is supposed to reflect the islands’ geographic distribution.

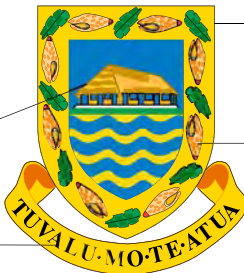
This flag was chosen because it symbolizes the continuing links with Britain and the Commonwealth.

However, anti-Commonwealth feeling rose and in 1995, the government decided on a new flag without the Union Jack. The new flag introduced later that year, retained the stars, but included the arms in a triangle at the hoist. In April 1997 the original design was re-adopted, following a change of government.

ARMS OF TUVALU

The coat of arms depicts a local meeting house or maneapa

The motto means “Tuvalu for God”



Eight sets of objects reflect the country's title, “Eight Together”

The border contains eight sea shells and eight banana leaves